

Saturday, 4 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

27° 16°

BIRMINGHAM

Drizzle

23° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

16° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Police are unhappy with the last-minute decision to extend pub opening hours for England's World Cup match on Monday morning.

The National Police Chiefs' Council says the announcement, allowing pubs to stay open until 5am, means officers will be pulled from other duties. It's certainly a big night for fans, but a headache for the police.

CRIME · UK

2

Three men have been found not guilty of the murder of journalist Lyra McKee, who was shot dead in Londonderry in 2019.

The 29-year-old was observing rioting when she was fatally shot. This verdict will undoubtedly be a significant talking point and a difficult day for her loved ones.

CRIME · UK

3

A teenager high on laughing gas has been jailed after using a car as a weapon, killing a mum-of-three.

Shelley Davies died in hospital three weeks after Kian Bateman drove into her and her partner. He's been sentenced for this tragic and senseless act.

CRIME · UK

4

A 'truly international network' of men drugging and raping women has been uncovered, according to the National Crime Agency.

Eight arrests have been made as the NCA identified 270 individuals linked to abuse websites. It's a shocking and deeply disturbing investigation.

CRIME · UK

5

A hosepipe ban has now been introduced for customers in Hampshire and the Isle of Wight.

Southern Water is following South East Water in bringing in restrictions. With the dry spell, it's a sign of the times for many areas.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **Rumours are swirling that Taylor Swift's wedding celebrations have begun in New York with a star-studded event.**

Actress Lena Dunham, model Gigi Hadid, and music producer Jack Antonoff were all spotted in formal wear near Madison Square Garden. It seems like the pop superstar might be tying the knot!

ON AIR – Would you rather be at a huge celebrity wedding like this, or a smaller, more intimate affair?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **More famous faces have been spotted arriving in New York ahead of Taylor Swift's rumoured wedding celebrations.**

Sabrina Carpenter and our very own Graham Norton were seen in the city. The guest list for this potential 'wedding of the year' is certainly growing!

ON AIR – If you could invite any celebrity to your wedding, who would it be and why?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **All the details about Taylor Swift's rumoured New York wedding celebrations are being kept top secret.**

It's being dubbed 'America's royal wedding,' with a lavish celebration at Madison Square Garden thought to be on the cards. Everyone's waiting for official confirmation!

ON AIR – What's the most extravagant wedding you've ever heard of, or even been to?

MUSIC · COMING UP

4 **The TV show 'Great Canal Journeys' is really a 'love story' according to actor Samuel West.**

He was unveiling a plaque to his parents, Timothy West and Prunella Scales, who starred in the much-loved series. A lovely tribute to a wonderful couple.

ON AIR – What's a TV show that you feel has a real 'heart' to it, and why do you love it?

TV · NOW

5 **The England World Cup squad's barber has been talking about trims and trust with the players.**

Ahmed Alsanawi, known as A-Star, is behind some of football's most famous haircuts. He's clearly got a big role in keeping the team looking sharp!

ON AIR – Do you get a special haircut for big occasions, or do you stick to your usual style?

FOOTBALL · NOW

On the schedule

1 **It's being called the biggest World Cup knockout mismatch: Lionel Messi's Argentina taking on Cape Verde.**

Fans are buzzing for this David versus Goliath clash, with Messi facing off against Vozinha. It promises to be quite the spectacle.

ON AIR – Do you love an underdog story in sport, or do you prefer to see the favourites dominate?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

2 **Former world number one Naomi Osaka has powered into the fourth round of Wimbledon for the very first time!**

She secured a confident win over Daria Kasatkina. It's a huge milestone for Osaka and she's certainly one to watch.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for the Wimbledon title this year, on both the men's and women's side?

TENNIS · UK

3 **Portugal have made it through to the last 16 of the World Cup after a dramatic victory over Croatia.**

Cristiano Ronaldo and Goncalo Ramos scored in a chaotic second half to win 2-1. They'll now face Iberian rivals Spain in the next round.

ON AIR – What's the most dramatic football match you've ever watched, with a crazy finish like this one?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

4 **Australia star Ellyse Perry is expected to be fit for Sunday's T20 World Cup final against England.**

This is great news for Australia, as Perry is a crucial all-rounder. It sets up a thrilling final between two fierce rivals.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the T20 World Cup final this weekend, and do you think England can win?

CRICKET · UK

5 **England captain Jamie George has backed his inexperienced replacement forwards against the Springboks in Johannesburg.**

He believes they can swing the match England's way in the final quarter. It's a big test for the squad against a formidable opponent.

ON AIR – When you're watching a rugby match, do you pay more attention to the starting XV or the impact of the players coming off the bench?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the gentle sound of rainfall can improve your concentration.**
Researchers found that the steady, non-intrusive sound helps to mask distracting noises, creating a calm environment perfect for focus.
- 2 The humble art of 'darning' socks is making a charming comeback as people embrace sustainable fashion.**
Instead of throwing away slightly worn items, more individuals are learning this traditional skill to extend the life of their favourite garments.
- 3 Experts are highlighting the mental health benefits of 'forest bathing', or simply spending mindful time among trees.**
This Japanese practice, known as Shinrin-yoku, is said to reduce stress and boost mood, connecting us with nature's calming influence.
- 4 A quirky new trend sees people creating 'miniature indoor gardens' in unconventional containers.**
From old teacups to clear glass jars, these tiny green spaces bring a touch of nature and a lot of charm to any desk or shelf.
- 5 Research suggests that the simple act of 'waving hello' to neighbours can significantly boost community spirit.**
Even a small friendly gesture helps to build connections and create a more welcoming atmosphere in local areas.
- 6 The surprising joy of 'board game cafes' is growing, offering a relaxed social alternative to traditional pubs.**
These venues provide a fantastic way for friends and families to connect over classic and new board games, enjoying good food and company.
- 7 Scientists have discovered that certain plants emit a 'squeaking sound' when they are thirsty.**
While inaudible to humans, these high-frequency noises could one day help farmers monitor the hydration levels of their crops.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with the biscuits, even when we know we probably shouldn't?

ANSWER: SAVING THE BEST ONES FOR OURSELVES!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to watch their favourite TV show. What is it?

ANSWER: MAKING A PERFECT CUP OF TEA OR COFFEE!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old hobby' you used to love as a child, and it brings you so much unexpected joy?

What's that forgotten pastime that's made a glorious return in your life, and why do you love it even more now?

- We all have those 'everyday sounds' that just make us feel instantly happy or relaxed, don't we?

Is it the kettle boiling, the birds singing in the morning, or perhaps the distant chimes of an ice cream van? What's your favourite comforting sound?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space-junk art project' that involves a satellite launching tiny, reflective cubes into orbit to create temporary, visible constellations.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can actually 'smell' the distinct aroma of space, which is often described as metallic and smoky.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.93 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.93 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- Cows have best friends and get stressed when they are separated.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.

On this day

Day 185 of the year, 180 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Antoine Daniel; Christian feast day: Andrew of Crete; Christian feast day: Bertha of Artois; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine Jarrige. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1931 — Stephen Boyd, Northern Ireland-born American actor (died 1977)
- 1966 — Lee Reherman, American actor (died 2016)
- 1943 — Alan Wilson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1970)
- 1966 — Ronni Ancona, Scottish actress and screenwriter
- 1918 — Alec Bedser, English cricketer (died 2010)
- 1965 — Gérard Watkins, English actor and playwright
- 1938 — Bill Withers, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2020)
- 1952 — John Waite, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1994 — Rwandan genocide: Kigali, the Rwandan capital, is captured by the Rwandan Patriotic Front, ending the genocide in the city.
- 2001 — Vladivostok Air Flight 352 crashes on approach to Irkutsk Airport killing all 145 people on board.
- 2024 — The Labour Party, led by Keir Starmer, wins a landslide majority in the 2024 United Kingdom general election, ending 14 years of Conservative government.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1054 — A supernova, called SN 1054, is seen by Chinese Song dynasty, Arab, and possibly Amerindian observers near the star Zeta Tauri. For several months it remains bright enough to be seen during the day. Its remnants form the Crab Nebula.
- 2009 — The first of four days of bombings begins on the southern Philippine island group of Mindanao.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1998 — Japan launches the Nozomi probe to Mars, joining the United States and Russia as a space exploring nation.

2009 — The Statue of Liberty's crown reopens to the public after eight years of closure due to security concerns following the September 11 attacks.

- 2004 — The cornerstone of the Freedom Tower is laid on the World Trade Center site in New York City.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 186 of the year, 179 days left in 2026. Today Bloody Thursday (International Longshore and Warehouse Union); Christian feast day: Anthony Maria Zaccaria, priest (died 1539); Christian feast day: Cyril and Methodius (a public holiday in Czech Republic and Slovakia); Christian feast day: Martha, mother of Simeon Stylites the Younger. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1929 — Tony Lock, English cricketer (died 1995)
- 1991 — Jason Dolley, American actor, musician and Twitch streamer
- 1982 — Dave Haywood, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — RZA, American rapper, producer, actor, and director
- 1916 — Ivor Powell, Welsh footballer (died 2012)
- 1949 — Jill Murphy, British children's author (died 2021)
- 1954 — Jimmy Crespo, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1979 — Shane Filan, Irish singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — Jeff Bezos founds Amazon.
- 1975 — Cape Verde gains its independence from Portugal.
- 2012 — The Shard in London is inaugurated as the tallest building in Europe, with a height of 310 metres (1,020 ft).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2009 — The largest hoard of Anglo-Saxon gold ever discovered in Britain, consisting of more than 1,500 items, is found near the village of Hammerwich, near Lichfield, Staffordshire.
- 1971 — The Twenty-sixth Amendment to the United States Constitution, lowering the voting age from 21 to 18 years, is formally certified by President Richard Nixon.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)